

what I used to fill up each of the disposal “sleeves.” When we need to reach for something to wipe up a spill or do a quick cleanup of a particular space, we can now reach for a washable cleaning rag instead of a paper towel.

5. Recycle old athletic socks

Not possible you say? I beg to differ. Cut each old sock off just slightly above the ankle, and below the ribbed leg section. The leftover foot portion is what I use instead of those expensive disposable dusting mittens. These things are great for getting around stair banister railings, and gripping table and chair legs to dust. You won’t go back, I promise you! The other ribbed section, particularly if it is ribbed the entire length of the piece, is great to slice up one side and use for a great moisture-holding dishrag. The ridges give you extra scrubbing power too.

6. Shopping for secondhand goods

Anything you are comfortable buying secondhand keeps that same item from ending up in a garbage dump. This applies to furniture, clothing, toys, kitchenware, and to a certain extent, automobiles. This personal finance procedure goes a long way toward helping out the planet and your pocketbook at the same time.

7. Think before you print

Save money on ink and paper by checking to see if you really need a paper copy of a particular document before hitting the print button. Still think you really need it? Check out the economy mode for printing which will at least use less ink and save you money in the long run on those re-filled cartridges.

8. Celebrate the power of tie-dye

This is a great affordable way to give lightly stained, lighter-colored linens and clothing items a second shelf life. Some ideas? Old sheets, curtains, pillowcases, socks, and T-shirts, to name a few.



9. Find a second use for those plastic grocery bags

These things really can help out a time or two more after making it home from the grocery store. Use them to